THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

Master of Business Administration
Course Code and Title: PMBA6134 AI in Financial Services: Leading Change in the Digital Era

I. Information on Instructor

Instructor: ALAIN LE COUEDIC
Email: ALECOU01@ICLOUD.COM
Phone: +852 9307 8916

II. Course Description and Objectives

- Course Description

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is here to stay and is already prevalent in many industry sectors. Among them, Financial Services offers a multitude of opportunities to use AI to create value. As Hong Kong is firming up its role as a leading global financial center (e.g,. in Capital Markets, Asset & Wealth Management), and the center for Financial Services in Asia, executives need to gain awareness of the transformative power of AI that will help them make the most of these technologies to grow revenues, decrease costs, make functions more effective and efficient, and spur innovation in their organizations. This course provides MBA students with a comprehensive understanding of AI and its transformative impact on the financial services sector. Through lectures, guest speakers from leading Financial Institutions, AI startups, industry associations, and Consulting firms, and group projects, students will explore how AI is reshaping banking, insurance, asset and wealth management, and related functions. The course emphasizes real-world applications, industry trends (e.g., GenAI, Agentic AI), and the strategic and operational implications of AI adoption for executives in this important sector where Hong Kong holds a leading position globally and regionally.

- Course objectives

1. Equip students with a foundational understanding of AI technologies and their current status in Financial Services,
2. Explore the application of AI across key Financial Services value chains, identifying pain points and solutions, opportunities to create value through AI in the sector,
3. Foster critical thinking about the ethical, regulatory, and managerial challenges of AI adoption in the Financial Services sector,
4. Provide practical insights from industry leaders, startups, and consultants on AI-driven innovation and transformation in Financial Services,
5. Develop students' ability to evaluate and recommend AI strategies for revenue generation, cost reduction, customer and operational excellence in Financial Institutions,
6. Inspire students to think strategically of AI as a key tool to drive innovation in organizations.

III. Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)

CLO1	Understand the core concepts and technologies of AI relevant to Financial Services and their practical applications for value creation
CLO2	Acknowledge the impact of AI on different segments of the Financial Services value chain in the various sub-industry verticals (e.g., retail banking, corporate/investment banking, insurance, asset and wealth management)

CLO3	Grasp the ethical, privacy, and regulatory considerations of AI deployment in the Financial Services sector
CLO4	Be able to contribute to formulating AI-driven business strategies that address real-world challenges in Financial Institutions
CLO5	Be in a position to effectively contribute in teams to research, present, and defend an AI-based solution for a Financial Services use case

IV. Alignment of Programme and Course LOs

MBA Programme Learning Outcomes	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)
PLO 1. Acquisition and internalization of business knowledge and skills in key functional areas	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3
PLO 2. Application of business knowledge to solve business problems	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3
PLO 3. Development of managerial leadership and inculcating professional ethics and competency in business	CLO3, CLO4, CLO5
PLO 4. Development of global outlook	CLO1, CLO4
PLO 5. Mastering communication skills	CLO4, CLO5

V. Teaching and Learning Activities (TLAs)

TLA#	Content	Aligned CLOs
TLA1	**Lectures**: Instructor-led sessions on AI concepts, trends, and applications in the financial services sector	All CLOs
TLA2	**Guest speakers:** Industry executives (e.g., DBS, HSBC, AXA, FWD, Ageas, Amundi, HSBC Asset Management, Google Cloud-- TBC), Startup founders (MioTech, Fano Labs, BeingAI, DeepOpinion-- TBC), and Association representatives (Hong Kong AI Association, Hong Kong Fintech Association-- TBC)	CLO2, CLO3, CLO4, CLO5
TLA3	**Case Studies, readings and discussions**: Analysis of real-world AI implementations and challenges (possibly, use of Global B-School case materials, as relevant)	CLO2
TLA4	**Class participation:** Students are encouraged to raise questions in class and actively participate in the class discussion	CLO5
TLA5	**Video Session(s):** Special session with e.g., DeepOpinion CEO on Agentic AI (based in Europe), Google Cloud banking and insurance use cases (based in Singapore)	CLO1, CLO2
TLA6	**Group project:** Collaborative research and presentation on AI solutions for Financial Services	CLO4, CLO5
TLA7	**Feedback and mentoring:** Continuous feedback on group work and presentations, including through office hours at HKU (once a week)	All CLOs

VI. Assessment

A#	Content	Description (Optional)	Weight	Aligned CLOs
A1	Class Participation - Attendance 15% - Discussions 15%	Attending all or most classes and participating in class discussions	30%	CLO1, CLO4, CLO5
A2	Final Quiz	20 Questions to answer in a concise manner (2-3 lines max) within 1.5 hour – Each graded on a 1-5 scale (i.e. max score of 100)	40%	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3
A3	Group project and readings - Group project 20% - Readings 10%	Short assignment over the course of the class, and regular readings following or in preparation for a class session. For readings: the teacher may conduct cold calling	30%	CLO4, CLO5

VII. Standard for Assessment

- **Course Grade Descriptors**

A+, A, A-	Demonstrate comprehensive understanding and curiosity of the topics covered in class, critical analysis, and innovative application of AI in financial services – Contributes insights to discussions and assignments, asks / answers questions during sessions –
B+, B, B-	Show solid understanding and application of course concepts
C+, C, C-	Meet basic requirements and demonstrate some understanding
D+, D	Limited understanding and application
F	Does not meet minimum requirements

- **Assessment Rubrics for Each Assessment**

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
Assessment Task: A1-Class Participation (Attendance and Discussions)	
Requirements to achieve top grade: A+, A, A-	Attend all classes. Demonstrate curiosity, frequently ask questions or contribute insights to discussions. Volunteer to contribute perspectives on the topic at hand based on professional/personal experience.
Assessment Task: A2-Final Quiz	
A+, A, A-	Achieve a score of >90, >85, >80 respectively
B+, B, B-	Achieve a score of >75, >70, >65 respectively
C+,C,C-	Achieve a score of >60>55>50 respectively
D+, D	Achieve a score of >45>40 respectively
F	Achieve a score of 40 or less
Assessment Task: A3-Group Project and Readings	

Requirements to achieve top grades: A+, A, A-	Group project: Content depth and high relevance of analyses and insights – Clarity, organization and professionalism of the document/presentation – Superior collaboration spirit and contribution, creativity in insight generation. Readings: Ability to adequately respond to questions during classes and presentations. Volunteer to comment on key messages of a given reading/ summarize most important aspects covered by the reading and learnings to keep in mind

VIII. Means/Processes for Student Feedback on Course

- ☐ Verbal feedback by the Instructor after Presentations
- ☐ Verbal feedback on written assignments (to be distributed within the course period) and questions on readings
- ☐ Summary "What have we learnt" after each day of class to highlight the important points to remember from that day
- ☐ Grade on the Final Quiz, with highlights on areas well mastered and those requiring improvement

IX. Academic Integrity

The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/.

Cheating or plagiarism of any kind would result in an automatic F grade for the course plus strict enforcement of all Faculty and/or University regulations regarding such behavior. Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to, the following types of cases:

a. **Plagiarism** - The representation of someone else's ideas as if they are one's own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.

b. **Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects** - The representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.

c. **Cheating on In-Class Exams** - The covert gathering of information from other students, the use of unauthorized notes, unauthorized aids, etc.

d. **Unauthorized Advance Access to an Exam** - The representation of materials prepared at leisure, as a result of unauthorized advance access (however obtained), as if it were prepared under the rigors of the exam setting. This misrepresentation is dishonest in itself even if there are not compounding factors, such as unauthorized uses of books or notes.

X. Course Content and Tentative Teaching Schedule

This is a **tentative teaching schedule** that will need to be confirmed after interactions with available external guests.

Day 1: Introduction to AI in Financial Services

Morning (9:00–12:30, incl. short break)

- **9:00–10:30:** Welcome & Introduction: The AI Revolution in Financial Services
- **10:30–10:45:** Break
- **10:45–12:30:** AI Landscape and Key Concepts

Afternoon (13:30–17:00)

- **13:30–14:30:** *Guest Speaker: Retail Banking Executive* (DBS or HSBC, TBC)
    - AI-driven transformation in retail banking: digital customer experience, fraud detection, and operational efficiency
- **14:30–15:30:** *Guest Speaker: Startup* (MioTech or Fano Labs, TBC)
    - AI applications in financial services: ESG analytics or NLP for compliance and customer service
- **15:30–15:45:** Break
- **15:45–17:00:** Group Formation & Assignment Launch

Day 2: AI Across Financial Services Value Chains – Opportunities for Value Creation

Morning (9:00–12:30)

- **9:00–10:30:** Retail Banking Value Chain: AI Applications on pain points and business opportunities
    - Deep dive with case studies from DBS/HSBC/Other banks (if not covered by guest)
- **10:30–10:45:** Break
- **10:45–12:30:** Corporate & Investment Banking Value Chain: AI Applications on pain points and business opportunities
    - Guest insights from HSBC (if present), otherwise lecture on AI in deal sourcing (Marketing and Sales), Middle Office, Back Office, Risk, and Compliance

Afternoon (13:30–17:00)

- **13:30–14:30:** Insurance Value Chain (Life & Non-Life): AI Applications on pain points and business opportunities
    - Guest insights from AXA or FWD
- **14:30–15:30:** *Guest Speaker: Startup* (BeingAI or alternative)
    - AI for customer engagement or digital interaction in financial services
- **15:30–15:45:** Break
- **15:45–17:00:** Group Work & Mentoring

Day 3: Deep Dive into AI Applications

Morning (9:00–12:30)

- **9:00–10:30:** Asset Management Value Chain: AI Applications on pain points and business opportunities
    - Guest insights from Amundi, HSBC Asset Management, Schroders or Neuberger Berman
- **10:30–10:45:** Break

- **10:45–12:30:** Wealth Management & Private Banking Value Chain: AI Applications
    - Focus on client profiling, personalized advice ("Next best action"), and compliance

Afternoon (13:30–17:00)

- **13:30–14:30:** *Guest Speaker: AI Association* (Artificial Intelligence Association of Hong Kong)
- **14:30–15:30:** *Guest Speaker: Wealth/Asset Management Executives* (e.g., Amundi or HSBC Asset Management)
- **15:30–15:45:** Break
- **15:45–17:00: Agentic AI in Financial Services**
    - Lecture and video interview with DeepOpinion CEO: trends, use cases, and implementation in banking, insurance, and other industry segments

---

Day 4: Special Topics in AI for Financial Services

Morning (9:00–12:30)

- **9:00–10:30:** Ethics, Privacy, Data Availability and Sharing, Explainability in AI
- **10:30–10:45:** Break
- **10:45–12:30:** Financial Inclusion and ESG: AI's Role

Afternoon (13:30–17:00)

- **13:30–14:30:** *Guest Speaker: Consultant/Expert* (Bain on OpenAI collaboration in Financial Services in Asia, or BCG X with case studies in Financial Services in the region)
- **14:30–15:30:** *Guest Speaker: Fintech Association* (Hong Kong Fintech Association)
- **15:30–15:45:** Break
- **15:45–17:00:** Group Work & Feedback Session

Day 5: Integration and Executive Insights

Morning (9:00–12:30)

- **9:00–10:45:** AI for Revenue Generation, Cost Reduction and Overall Transformation in Financial Services
- **10:45–11:00:** Break
- **11:00–12:30:** Final Quiz for the course

Afternoon (13:30–17:00)

- **13:30–15:00:** Group Presentations
- **15:00–15:15:** Break
- **15:15–17:00:** Closing Discussion & Next Steps (with all guest participants for Q&A and panel discussion

XI. Additional Course Information

N/A
